fiction, but "that a corporation is more nearly a method than a thing," and is merely "a name for a useful and usual collection of jural relations." [14]

Mr. Justice Oliver Wendell Holmes, undoubtedly the greatest jurist of our times, wrote to me on Dec. 19, 1923, that he regards the conception of corporate personality as a fiction, adding, however, "but as I said when young, on the Massachusetts bench, the very meaning of the fiction is that you are to act as if it was true."

After listening to all this fusillade, most of you will doubtless exclaim, with Warwick in Shakespeare's King Henry VI,

> "But in these nice, sharp quillets of the law,
> Good faith, I am no wiser than a daw."

Where the wise men differ, how can the layman be expected to see the light?

The late John Chipman Gray of Harvard, with the good sense that always characterized his utterances, said in his book on the Nature and Sources of the Law, that he would not undertake to solve the problem whether a corporation is "a real or only a fictitious entity," because "everybody is born either a Nominalist or a Realist." I am not

[14] *Farmers' Loan & Trust Co.* v. *Pierson*, 130 Misc. Rep. 110, 116–7, 222 N. Y. Supp. 532, *per* Bijur, J.

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